

SHOOT DAY BRIEF

Is the American Dream Dead?



PROJECT	YouTube Long-Form — BTTF Concept
TALENT	Graeham Watts (Intero Real Estate)
VIDEOGRAPHER	Wesley
SHOOT DATE	
LOCATIONS	3 properties + 1 neighborhood walk
TOTAL LIVE SHOTS	11 (6 primary + 3 secondary + 2 neighborhood)
EST. SHOOT TIME	3-4 hours (incl. setup + travel)

All voiceover narration for B-roll cutaways already recorded.
This document covers on-camera, on-location moments only.
Tone for everything in here: grounded, conversational, real estate agent talking to a buyer.

CHEAT SHEET — ALL SHOTS AT A GLANCE

SHOT	WHAT	WHERE	FRAMING	MOVEMENT	TAKES
A1	HOOK — opener of the entire video	Primary house exterior	MCU phone-style	Static	4-5
A2	DeLorean keys close-up	Same as A1	ECU rack focus	Rack focus	2-3
A3	Bay Area Receipt — pull-up to property	Primary house exterior	WS → MCU gimbal	Gimbal track	3
A4	Workaround intro — agent mode	Front door of primary house	MCU	Static	3
A5	The 4-Step Path — walking through interior	Primary house interior	MCU gimbal walk	Tracking	2-3
A6	CLOSING — mirrors A1 (same spot, same lens)	Primary house exterior	MCU phone-style	Static	3-4
B1	Duplex / starter exterior	Secondary house	WS exterior	Push-in	2
B2	Key in door / hand close-up	Secondary house	ECU hands	Static / slider	2
B3	"For Sale" sign / real estate visual	Secondary house or anywhere	MS	Static	2
C1	Society walking shot — contemplative	Residential street EPA/RWC	MS gimbal track	Tracking walk	2-3
C2	Neighborhood B-roll (silent)	Same residential street	Various WS	Push-ins	~6 clips

SUGGESTED SHOOT ORDER

MORNING (soft light): Block C (neighborhood walk + B-roll) → Block B (secondary house exterior)

MIDDAY (flat / overcast OK): Block A interior shots — A4, A5

GOLDEN HOUR (KEY): A1, A2, A3, A6 — all primary house exterior in the same light window

A1

THE HOOK

PRIMARY HOUSE EXTERIOR • MOST IMPORTANT SHOT OF THE VIDEO

FRAMING	MCU (waist up). Phone-style — slightly tighter than traditional MS, feels like a selfie call. Graeham on left third, house behind on right two-thirds.
LENS	35mm or 50mm. NOT 85mm — too compressed.
MOVEMENT	Static. Locked off is fine. Minimal handheld drift OK.
LIGHTING	Golden hour. Sun behind Graeham at 3/4 angle. Reflector bounce to fill the face.
AUDIO	Lav primary. Boom backup if wind.

ACTION

Talking direct to lens. Calm but direct. No movement until the final line. On the final line ("I'm gonna need these...") Graeham reaches into pocket and pulls out the DeLorean keys. Don't cut — get the reach and dangle.

SCRIPT — SHOT A1

4-5 takes preferred

"The median age of a first-time homebuyer in America is now **40 years old.**"

[PAUSE — hold silence for 1 full second. Don't rush.]

"In 1992, it was 28."

"That's not a generation being lazy. That's a generation losing twelve years of wealth-building — and most of you watching this are inside that twelve-year gap right now."

"I'm a real estate agent in one of the most expensive markets in the country. And I've spent the last week digging into seventy years of housing data to answer one question: **when did the American Dream actually break, who broke it, and is there any version of it left worth chasing?**"

"The answer is more complicated than either side will tell you."

"So here's the deal. To do this right, I'm gonna need *these...*"

[Reach into pocket, pull out DeLorean keys, dangle in front of lens. DO NOT CUT.]

TAKES USED:

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS

A2

DELOREAN KEYS

SAME SPOT AS A1 • RACK FOCUS CLOSE-UP

FRAMING	ECU on the keys in Graeham's hand. DMC logo visible. Background falls away completely.
LENS	85mm if available (shallow DOF). 50mm acceptable.
MOVEMENT	Slow rack focus — start on face OUT of focus, rack to keys SHARP.
LIGHTING	Same golden hour conditions as A1. Don't move lights.
AUDIO	Capture clean — this line is V/O but Wesley should still record it.

ACTION

Graeham dangles the DeLorean keys at lens. Light jingle. Camera racks focus from his face (soft) to the keys (sharp). Hold on sharp keys for 2 beats.

SCRIPT — SHOT A2

2-3 takes

"We're getting in the DeLorean. We're going back to 1955, 1975, 1995, 2015, and then forward to today. Same four questions every stop. Let's go."

TAKES USED:

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS

A3

BAY AREA RECEIPT

PULL-UP TO PRIMARY HOUSE • GIMBAL WALK + STOP

FRAMING	Start WS (full body + whole house visible). End MCU (Graeham stopped, facing camera).
LENS	24-35mm wide for WS start. Same lens through the move.
MOVEMENT	Gimbal tracking from behind/side as Graeham walks up the driveway or walkway. End on him turning to face camera.
LIGHTING	Same golden hour as A1 + A6. Sun behind Graeham at 3/4.
AUDIO	Lav + boom backup. Watch for footsteps on lav.

ACTION

Graeham walks 3-4 steps up the path/driveway. Turns to face camera at the door or midpoint. Delivers script. Gestures to the house on the "EPA \$1.02 million" line.

SCRIPT — SHOT A3

3 takes

"Bay Area, where I work? East Palo Alto median: **one point oh two million**. San Mateo County: **one point eight million**. Single-family in San Mateo County: **two point one eight million**."

[Gesture to the house behind you.]

"Average down payment in San Jose: **two hundred and thirty-five thousand dollars**. That's not the home. That's the down payment."

[Land "that's the down payment" with subtle disbelief — punchy, not preachy.]

TAKES USED:

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS

FRAMING	MCU. Could also do OTS with the door slightly open behind him — agent about to walk a buyer through.
LENS	50mm.
MOVEMENT	Static.
LIGHTING	Door / porch ambient. Fill if needed.
AUDIO	Lav primary.

ACTION

Direct to camera. Tone shifts to "agent mode" — confident, helpful, slightly leaning forward. Keys in hand optional for casual visual cue.

SCRIPT — SHOT A4

3 takes

"I'm a real estate agent. I work with first-time buyers in this market every week. Let me tell you what I tell them."

"The 20 percent down myth needs to die. **You do not need 20 percent down to buy in the Bay Area.** Conventional loans go to 3 percent. FHA goes to 3.5 percent. CalHFA, MyHome Assistance, the City of East Palo Alto first-time buyer program — there are real working programs in San Mateo County right now offering 10 thousand to 40 thousand dollars in down payment assistance."

TAKES USED:

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS

FRAMING	MCU on Graeham, moving smoothly as he walks. House features visible behind him without distracting.
LENS	35mm.
MOVEMENT	Slow gimbal tracking. Wesley walks backward, Graeham walks toward camera. Talking-while-walking shot.
LIGHTING	Natural interior + bounce/fill for face. Watch for hot windows.
AUDIO	Lav primary. Watch for shoe noise on hardwood.

ACTION

Walk through entryway → living room → kitchen or back porch. Like showing a buyer the house. Brief gestures to features as relevant — gesture to property on "duplex or ADU" line. Gesture outward on "fringe markets."

SCRIPT — SHOT A5 (LONGER — GET 2-3 CLEAN TAKES)

2-3 takes

"The actual path to ownership in 2026 isn't 'save two hundred and thirty-five thousand dollars.' It's four moves."

"**One** — house-hack. Buy a duplex or a property with an ADU. Rent out one unit, live in the other. The tenant pays your mortgage."

"**Two** — three to five percent down conventional or FHA, stacked with first-time buyer assistance. Programs like CalHFA can layer with your loan."

"**Three** — buy in an appreciating fringe market. East Palo Alto, Redwood City, parts of San Mateo. Not Palo Alto, not Atherton. The fringe is where the math still works."

"**Four** — hold for seven years. Real estate is a long game. You're not flipping. You're building."

"The system is what it is. But there are still *doors*. They're just smaller, and you have to know where they are."

[Land "doors" with weight — this is the section's closing image.]

TAKES USED:

☐

1

☐

2

☐

3

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS

FRAMING	MCU. Phone-style. IDENTICAL to A1. Same lens, same spot, same angle.
LENS	Same as A1 (35mm or 50mm — whichever was used).
MOVEMENT	Static.
LIGHTING	Same golden hour conditions as A1. Schedule for same lighting window. If lighting drifts, reshoot A1.
AUDIO	Lav primary. Boom backup.

ACTION

Direct to lens. Grounded, sincere tone. Long shot — about 1:50 on camera. Will likely break into 3-4 take segments in edit. At end, reach for DeLorean keys on a surface next to Graeham (or pull from pocket), jingle once, smile, walk out of frame. Hold the empty frame 2-3 seconds.

SCRIPT — SHOT A6 (LONG — BREAK INTO SEGMENTS)

3-4 takes

"So — is the American Dream dead?"

[PAUSE — sit on it. Don't rush.]

"No."

[Another pause — let "No" breathe.]

"But the version your grandparents had — one income, one career, one mortgage, one house, send the kid to college on it — **that version is dead.** It got priced out by 45 years of policy choices that shifted economic gains toward the top of the ladder. Both parties signed off. Both parties benefited."

"And whatever you think the fix is — more market, less market, more taxes, fewer taxes, more housing supply, more programs — I'm not going to be the one to tell you. That's your call, and that's why we vote."

"What I *can* tell you is what's possible right now, in 2026, in the Bay Area I work in."

"A different dream. Smaller. More creative. Two incomes minimum. House-hacking instead of single-family. Geographic flexibility. Down payment assistance instead of saving alone. Multigenerational ownership."

"The dream isn't gone. It just costs more, takes longer, and requires you to know things nobody taught you. **That's what this channel is for.**"

"If you want my actual playbook for buying in the Bay Area in 2026 — every program, every neighborhood, every workaround I just walked through — **comment OPTIONS below and I'll DM it to you. It's free.**"

"And in the comments: tell me what you think. Is the dream dead? Did it just change shape? What's the real fix? I read every one — and I genuinely want the conversation, not just the agreement."

[Pause. Reach for DeLorean keys. Jingle once. Smile.]

"Catch you next week."

[Walk out of frame. Hold empty frame 2-3 seconds before cutting.]

TAKES USED:

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS

FRAMING	WS exterior of smaller starter or duplex.
LENS	24mm-35mm wide.
MOVEMENT	Slow drone-style ground push-in (if drone). Otherwise slider or smooth gimbal walk-in.
LIGHTING	Whatever — morning or midday OK. This is B-roll.
AUDIO	Ambient only. No dialogue.

ACTION

Wide static-to-push-in on duplex or smaller starter home. 6-8 second clean clip. Cutaway over "house-hack a duplex or ADU" line in A5.

TAKES USED:

☐

1

☐

2

NOTES

FRAMING	ECU on hands and keys.
LENS	85mm or 50mm macro.
MOVEMENT	Static or slow slider.
LIGHTING	Door ambient. Fill if shadow on hands.
AUDIO	Key sound capture would be nice.

ACTION

Hand turning key in lock OR close-up of keys being handed over. Multiple angles if time allows. Cutaway visual for ownership / fringe-market beats.

TAKES USED:☐ 1☐ 2**NOTES**



FOR SALE SIGN

REAL ESTATE VISUAL SIGNAL • SILENT B-ROLL

FRAMING	MS, with house in background. Sign should fill most of frame.
LENS	50mm.
MOVEMENT	Static or very slow drift.
LIGHTING	Natural.
AUDIO	Ambient only.

ACTION

Clean shot of any current listing sign (Graeham's name visible ideal). General "real estate" cutaway visual.

TAKES USED:

☐ 1☐ 2

NOTES

FRAMING	MS. Some street/neighborhood context visible. Wesley walks backward, Graeham walks toward camera.
LENS	35mm.
MOVEMENT	Smooth gimbal tracking. Moderate walking pace — not slow, not rushed.
LIGHTING	Late afternoon or early morning soft directional light. Tree-shaded street is great.
AUDIO	Lav. Wind screen if needed.

ACTION

Walking, contemplative. Reflective tone, not energetic. Heaviest tonal moment in the video. Stop walking on the last line ("It got priced out") if it works naturally.

SCRIPT — SHOT C1

2-3 takes (try different streets/directions)

"Here's where it stops being a housing story and becomes a society story."

"50 years ago, half of all 25-to-34-year-olds had hit the four classic adulthood milestones: full-time job, married, kid, owned a home."

"Today: **less than one in four**. U.S. Census Bureau, 2025."

"Why? Because everything got delayed. Median first-time homebuyer age: 40. Marriage age: up. U.S. birth rate hit a record low in 2024. Multigenerational households — three generations under one roof — are at levels we haven't seen since the 1800s."

"People frame this as a lifestyle choice. 'Millennials are different.' 'Gen Z chose differently.' But look at the actual research — Harvard's Joint Center for Housing Studies, the Heritage Foundation, peer-reviewed fertility research — **they all point to the same cause: housing cost.**"

"You can't get married in your parents' basement. You can't have kids in a one-bedroom apartment. You can't move closer to a better job if you can't afford the rent. The dream didn't get rejected. **It got priced out.**"

[Stop walking on the last line if it feels natural. Don't force it.]

TAKES USED:

☐ 1☐ 2☐ 3

NOTES / TAKE COMMENTS



NEIGHBORHOOD B-ROLL

SILENT ESTABLISHING SHOTS • CUTS OVER SOCIETY SECTION

FRAMING	Various WS — tree-lined street, mailboxes, fences, family-living signals.
LENS	24mm-35mm wide.
MOVEMENT	Slow push-ins, slow tilts. No fast movement.
LIGHTING	Same as C1 window.
AUDIO	Ambient.

ACTION

Aim for 6 clean establishing clips. Each 5-8 seconds. These cut over the marriage / kids / multigenerational beats in C1's voiceover.

SHOT LIST — GET ALL SIX IF POSSIBLE

1. Tree-lined residential street, no people, slow push-in
2. House with "For Sale" sign (if any in neighborhood)
3. Mailboxes / fences as visual texture
4. Kids' bikes in driveways / family-living signal
5. Empty playground or stroller / quiet street
6. Long lens compression of street with parked cars

NOTES / WHICH GOT CAPTURED

EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST + LOGISTICS

CAMERA BODY + LENSES

- ☐ A7S III (or Wesley's primary body)
- ☐ 24-70mm zoom
- ☐ 35mm prime (for A1, A6 hero shots)
- ☐ 50mm prime (for A4, B3)
- ☐ 85mm prime (for A2 rack focus, B2 hands)

STABILIZATION + MOVEMENT

- ☐ Gimbal (Ronin / Crane — Wesley's preference)
- ☐ Tripod (for static A1, A6)
- ☐ Slider (for B2 macro slide)
- ☐ Drone if available (for B1 push-in)

AUDIO

- ☐ Lav mic (primary — Sennheiser G4 or equivalent)
- ☐ Boom + windscreen (backup)
- ☐ Spare batteries x4
- ☐ Spare TX/RX batteries

LIGHTING

- ☐ 5-in-1 reflector (silver / white)
- ☐ Small LED panel for interior fill (Aputure MC or similar)
- ☐ Diffusion / softbox if available

MEDIA + POWER

- ☐ Camera batteries x4

- ☐ SD/CFexpress cards x4 (formatted, empty)
- ☐ External monitor (optional, useful for A5 walking shot)
- ☐ Phone with shot list (this PDF) loaded

OTHER

- ☐ Wardrobe — Graeham's normal day clothes (NOT costume)
- ☐ DeLorean keys prop (Graeham brings)
- ☐ Water, snacks
- ☐ House keys / listing access

SHOOT DAY FLOW

7:30 AM — SOFT LIGHT WINDOW OPENS

Block C: Society walk (C1) + Neighborhood B-roll (C2). Residential street.

9:30 AM — MOVE TO SECONDARY HOUSE

Block B: Duplex exterior (B1) + keys (B2) + For Sale sign (B3). Quick — 30 min.

10:30 AM — MOVE TO PRIMARY HOUSE (INTERIOR TIME)

Block A Interior: Workaround intro (A4) at front door + 4-step path (A5) interior gimbal walk.

12:00 PM — LUNCH BREAK

Eat. Hydrate. Reset.

1:00 PM — OPTIONAL COVERAGE / RESHOOT BUFFER

Use this window to reshoot anything from the morning if needed. Or grab additional B-roll cutaways.

5:30 PM — GOLDEN HOUR (CRITICAL)

Block A Exterior: A1 (Hook) → A2 (keys close-up) → A3 (Bay Area Receipt walk-up) → A6 (Closing — mirrors A1).
Lighting between A1 and A6 must match. Plan tight.

7:00 PM — WRAP

Verify all takes captured. Pack up. Transfer cards to backup drive on-site if possible.

THE ONE THING THAT CANNOT BE MISSED

A1 (Hook) and A6 (Closing) MUST be shot in the same light window. They are the first and last shots of the video and the viewer's eye will detect lighting drift instantly. If golden hour is interrupted by clouds, prioritize A1 and A6 over everything else and reshoot any interior shots another day if needed.

The pauses in A1 and A6 are intentional. After "40 years old" in A1, and after "No" in A6, Graeham sits in silence. Don't cut, don't push. The silence is the shot.